

the cursor and initiating new draw commands. The following object draws a curved arrow using a series of lines and cubic Bezier curves:

```

• <s:Path data="M 20 0
  C 50 0 50 35 20 35
  L 15 35 L 15 45
  L 0 32 L 15 19
  L 15 29 L 20 29
  C 44 29 44 6 20 6">
• <s:stroke>
• <s:SolidColorStrokecolor="0x888888"/>
• </s:stroke>
• <s:fill>
• <s:LinearGradient rotation="90">
• <s:GradientEntrycolor="0x000000" alpha="0.8"/>
• <s:GradientEntrycolor="0xFFFFF" alpha="0.8"/>
• </s:LinearGradient>
• </s:fill>
• </s:Path>

```

Adding visual effects

The primitive vector graphic classes support many properties that enable you to modify their appearance. Examples include gradient fills and strokes, drop shadows and other filters, and scaling, or resizing, of vector graphics. In this section we look at some of the most commonly used effects from which you can choose.

Using gradient fills

The fill property that's supported by the Rect, Ellipse, and Path classes can be set to a solid color with the SolidColor class or to a gradient with either RadialGradient or LinearGradient. Each does exactly what its name implies:

- ▶ **LinearGradient** - Defines a change in colours in a linear using calculation from one coordinate to another. By default the gradient is calculated from left to right, but it can be adjusted by changing the gradient class's direction property; for example, to change the gradient to go from top to bottom, change the LinearGradient object's direction to 90.
- ▶ **RadialGradient** - Defines a change in colours starting from the certain point in an object (by default its centre) and radiating outward to its borders. You can set the focalPoint Ratio and rotation properties to